ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

# GRADE 8

# SOCIAL SCIENCES

## PRACTICE EXAM 3

**MARKS: 100** **TIME: 2 hours**

**Section A: Geography (50) – grid references, direction and distance, types of maps, time zones, factors affecting climate, relief rain, savanna, the settlement hierarchy, urban problems, transport and trade.**
**Section B: History (50) – railways and industrialisation in southern Africa, life in the mine compounds, effects of colonialism in Africa, and South Africans at Delville Wood.**

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

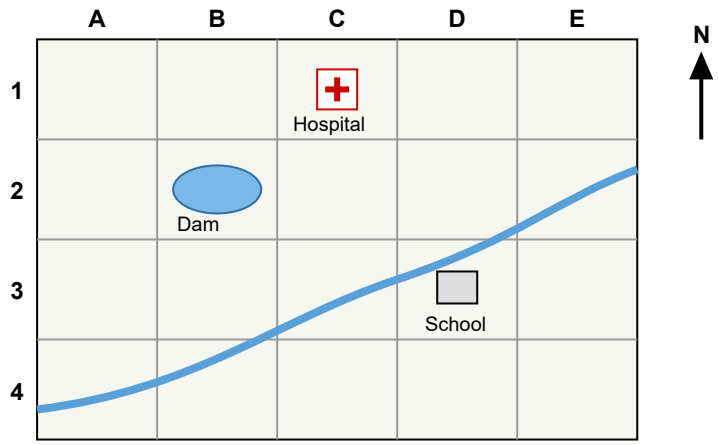
## INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of TWO sections: SECTION A: Geography (50 marks) and SECTION B: History (50 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions in BOTH sections.
3. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
4. Read the sources carefully before you answer the questions on them. The sources were written for this examination and are based on historical facts.
5. Show ALL calculations. A non-programmable calculator may be used.

## SECTION A: GEOGRAPHY

## QUESTION 1: MAPS AND GLOBES

**1.1** Study the sketch map. Each grid square represents 1 km × 1 km.




1.1.1 Give the grid square of (a) the dam and (b) the school. (2)

1.1.2 Which feature is found in grid square C1? (1)

1.1.3 In which direction is the school from the dam? (1)

1.1.4 The centre of the dam is in the middle of its square, and so is the school. Use the Theorem of Pythagoras to calculate the straight-line distance between them. (2)

1.1.5 Calculate the total area covered by the sketch map. (1)

**1.2** Name TWO types of maps and say what each type shows. (2)

**1.3** Why are positions on maps sometimes given in degrees and minutes, instead of only degrees? (1)

**1.4** The Earth turns through 15° of longitude every hour. When it is 12:00 sun time at 30°E, what is the sun time at a place at 45°W? Show your working. (2)

**1.5** Explain why the world is divided into 24 time zones. (2)

**1.6** What is a GPS used for? (1)

**[15]**

## QUESTION 2: CLIMATE

**2.1** Bloemfontein and Durban are at almost the same latitude, but Bloemfontein has much colder winters. Give TWO reasons for this difference. (3)

**2.2** Study the average temperatures of two towns.

| Town | Height above sea level | January (°C) | July (°C) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Town P (on the coast) | 10 m | 25 | 18 |
| Town Q (inland) | 1 400 m | 22 | 8 |

2.2.1 Calculate the temperature range of each town. (2)

2.2.2 Why does Town Q have a much larger temperature range? (2)

2.2.3 Which town is more likely to have frost in winter? (1)

**2.3** (a) Explain, step by step, how mountains cause relief rain. (b) What is a rain shadow? (4)

**2.4** (a) Describe the natural vegetation of a savanna region. (b) Name ONE area of South Africa with savanna vegetation. (3)

**2.5** (a) Explain how climate influences where people choose to live. (b) Name ONE crop that grows well in the winter-rainfall region of the Western Cape. (3)

**[18]**

## QUESTION 3: SETTLEMENT, TRANSPORT AND TRADE

**3.1** Arrange these settlements from the smallest to the largest: city, village, hamlet, metropolis, town (2)

**3.2** Explain why a city offers many more services (such as hospitals and universities) than a village. (2)

**3.3** Many people in large cities live in informal settlements. Give TWO problems that people in informal settlements face, and suggest TWO solutions. (4)

**3.4** Name ONE form of public transport in South African cities and give ONE advantage of using it. (2)

**3.5** (a) What is globalisation? (b) Which country is South Africa's largest trading partner? (3)

**3.6** Why are seaports important for South Africa's economy? (2)

**3.7** Explain why many factories are located close to the harbour in Durban. (2)

**[17]**

**TOTAL SECTION A: [50]**

# SECTION B: HISTORY

## QUESTION 4: INDUSTRIALISATION IN SOUTHERN AFRICA

Read Source A and answer the questions.

> **SOURCE A: Railways in southern Africa**
>
> The discovery of diamonds and gold led to a rush to build railways. The line from Cape Town reached Kimberley in 1885 and Johannesburg in 1892. Railways from Durban and from Lourenço Marques soon followed. The railways carried machinery, coal and food to the mines, and brought thousands of migrant workers to the mining towns.

**4.1** In which year did the railway line from Cape Town reach Kimberley? (1)

**4.2** What is Lourenço Marques called today? (1)

**4.3** Name TWO things that the railways carried to the mines. (2)

**4.4** Why did the mines need railways? (2)

**4.5** How did the railways change the lives of people in rural areas? (2)

**4.6** Give ONE similarity between the Industrial Revolution in Britain and industrialisation in South Africa. (2)

**4.7** Name TWO inventions of the Industrial Revolution in Britain. (2)

**4.8** What did the British Factory Act of 1833 do? (2)

**4.9** Why was Manchester nicknamed "Cottonopolis"? (2)

**[16]**

## QUESTION 5: LIFE ON THE MINES

Read Source B and answer the questions.

> **SOURCE B: Life in the compounds**
>
> Workers lived in large barracks, often twenty or more men to a room, sleeping on concrete bunks. They could not leave the compound without permission. Diseases such as pneumonia and tuberculosis spread quickly, and many men died in rockfalls and accidents underground.

**5.1** Give TWO living conditions in the compounds described in Source B. (2)

**5.2** Why did diseases spread so quickly in the compounds? (2)

**5.3** Why were workers not allowed to leave the compounds freely? (2)

**5.4** What was the job colour bar on the mines? (2)

**5.5** Give ONE reason why the wages of black mineworkers stayed low. (2)

**5.6** Name the lung disease caused by breathing in rock dust underground. (1)

**5.7** Who found the gold reef on the farm Langlaagte in 1886? (1)

**5.8** How did the migrant labour system affect the women who stayed behind in rural areas? (2)

**5.9** "The Mineral Revolution was the start of South Africa's modern economy." Do you agree? Explain your answer. (3)

**[17]**

## QUESTION 6: COLONIALISM AND THE FIRST WORLD WAR

**6.1** (a) Give ONE example of African resistance to colonial rule. (b) Explain why the borders drawn by Europeans at the Berlin Conference caused problems for Africa. (c) Give TWO negative effects of colonialism on Africa. (5)

**6.2** Name the two alliances of the First World War and ONE country in each. (2)

**6.3** Read Source C and answer the questions.

> **SOURCE C: Delville Wood**
>
> In July 1916 the South African Brigade was ordered to capture Delville Wood in France and to hold it at all costs. For six days the soldiers fought under heavy German shelling and machine-gun fire. Of about 3 150 South Africans who went into the wood, only about 780 answered the roll call when they came out.

6.3.1 When and where did this battle take place? (2)

6.3.2 What were the South Africans ordered to do? (1)

6.3.3 Calculate approximately what percentage of the soldiers did not answer the roll call. (2)

6.3.4 Why were the losses in battles like this so heavy? (2)

6.3.5 Why is this war called a "world" war? (3)

**[17]**

**TOTAL SECTION B: [50]**

**TOTAL: 100**

**END OF QUESTION PAPER**